Contract Review and Escalation Guidelines

Introduction

This document outlines HelioFreight's internal standards for managing contract changes with customers, carriers, and strategic vendors. It establishes consistent roles, controls, and decision points to reduce cycle time while protecting commercial and legal interests. The guidance supports cross-functional alignment across Sales, Operations, Legal, and Finance for North American 3PL engagements. Adherence to these guidelines helps ensure timely execution and enforceable contractual terms.

Commercial Risk and Terms Framework

To accelerate contract redline approval within HelioFreight's commercial risk and terms framework, the first control point is opening a new CLM Deal Intake record for the opportunity and completing it with decision-grade data. The intake must reflect the customer's exact legal entity name for contracting purposes, clearly define whether the requested service scope covers freight, warehousing, or a bundled solution, and include an annualized revenue estimate to support commercial authority thresholds. Teams must also document the target start date, enumerate every facility and location impacted (including multi-site rollouts), and specify the requested signature deadline to align legal review SLAs and escalation triggers. Once the required fields are entered, the record is saved so the CLM can apply automated routing, gating, and approval rules that determine who reviews the redlines and in what sequence. Consistent intake discipline reduces rework, prevents misrouting, and ensures the contract is evaluated against the correct risk posture and term standards before redlines are negotiated or approved.

Conclusion

Consistent application of these guidelines improves contract turnaround, reduces rework, and strengthens compliance. Clear routing and accountable decision-making help teams resolve issues efficiently without compromising service commitments or margin protection. Proper documentation and audit controls ensure that approved terms are retrievable and defensible. Leaders are responsible for reinforcing these practices and addressing recurring bottlenecks through continuous improvement.